

Word family: **survive / survives / survived / surviving / survival / survivor**

Base word: survive

Past tense: survived

Past participle: survived

-ing form: surviving

Related forms: survival, survivor

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun forms (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “They seem peaceful, but they also **survive** long journeys and harsh natural conditions.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **survive** means to **continue living despite danger, difficulty, or harsh conditions**.

繁體中文：***在危險、困難或惡劣環境下仍然活下來；生存下來**

中文翻譯：

> “...they also **survive** long journeys and harsh natural conditions.”

「.....但牠們同時也能在漫長旅程和惡劣自然環境中**生存下來**。」

Here:

survive harsh conditions = 在惡劣環境下仍能存活

1. **survive = stay alive despite danger/difficulty (生命) — 生存；存活**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To continue living despite danger, injury, illness, lack of resources, or difficult conditions.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Sea turtles **survive** long journeys and harsh natural conditions.”

「海龜能在漫長旅程和惡劣自然環境中**存活**。」

Practice 2

> “Very few plants can **survive** in such dry conditions.”

「很少植物能在如此乾旱的環境中**生存**。」

Practice 3

> “The animal **survived** the winter.”

「那隻動物**熬過 / 存活過**冬天。」

survive = 面對危險、惡劣環境、疾病或其他威脅時仍繼續活着

Common:

- * survive an accident
- * survive an illness
- * survive the winter
- * survive harsh conditions

2. **survive** = remain in existence (事物 / 組織) — 留存；繼續存在

Survive can apply to things that are not alive.

Practice 4

> “Several ancient buildings have **survived**.”

「幾座古老建築一直**保存 / 留存至今**。」

Practice 5

> “The tradition has **survived** for hundreds of years.”

「這項傳統已經**延續**了數百年。」

survive = 某個制度、傳統、建築、作品等在時間或變化中仍然存在

This is a major figurative extension of the life sense.

3. **survive** = continue operating despite difficulty (企業 / 系統) — 撐下去；維持下去

A business, organization, or system can **survive** if it continues operating despite difficult

circumstances.

Practice 6

> “Many small businesses struggled to ****survive****.”

「很多小型企業都努力****維持下去 / 撐下去****。」

Practice 7

> “The organization cannot ****survive**** without funding.”

「這個機構如果沒有資金便無法****維持運作****。」

****survive = 在財務、競爭、危機或其他壓力下仍然繼續存在 / 運作****

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 under the broad concept:

> ****continue to exist****

4. ****survive = live longer than someone (比某人長壽) — 比.....活得久 ; 在.....死後仍在世****

This is an important distinct meaning.

Practice 8

> “She ****survived**** her husband by ten years.”

「她比丈夫****多活了十年****。」

Practice 9

> “He is ****survived by**** two children.”

「他身後留下兩名子女。」

****survive someone = 比某人活得更久，在對方死後仍然在世****

The passive construction:

> ****be survived by...****

is especially common in obituaries and formal notices.

5. **survive = get through an unpleasant experience (比喻 / 口語) — 熬過 ; 撐過**

In informal English, **survive** can exaggerate the idea of enduring something difficult, tiring, boring, or stressful.

Practice 10

> “I somehow **survived** the three-hour meeting.”

「我總算**熬過了**那場三小時的會議。」

Practice 11

> “How did you **survive** the exam week?”

「你是怎樣**撐過**考試週的？」

survive = 成功捱過一段令人疲累、困難或不愉快的經歷

This is figurative and often humorous.

For core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 1 as an extension of **endure and get through**.

6. **survive on something (靠.....維生) — 靠.....生存**

A very common construction is:

> **survive on + food/money/resources**

Practice 12

> “The animals can **survive on** very little food.”

「這些動物只靠很少食物也能**生存**。」

Practice 13

> “He had to **survive on** a very small income.”

「他不得不靠很低的收入**維持生活**。」

survive on something = 依靠有限的食物、金錢或資源維持生命 / 生活

This belongs to the main survival sense.

Related form: **survival**

Survival means the state or fact of continuing to live or exist.

**survival = staying alive (生存) **

Practice 14

> “Food and water are essential for **survival**.”

「食物和水對**生存**非常重要。」

**survival = continued existence (存續) **

Practice 15

> “The company’s **survival** depends on reducing costs.”

「公司的**存續**取決於能否降低成本。」

survival = 面對威脅、困難或時間變化仍繼續生存 / 存在

Related form: **survivor**

A **survivor** is someone or something that survives.

Practice 16

> “She was the only **survivor** of the accident.”

「她是事故中唯一的**生還者**。」

Practice 17

> “The tree is a remarkable **survivor**.”

「這棵樹的生命力非常頑強，是個出色的**存活者**。」

survivor = 經歷危險、災難、疾病等後仍然活着的人 / 生物

Related form: **surviving**

Surviving can mean still alive or still existing.

Practice 18

> “The **surviving** members of the group returned home.”

「小組中仍然**生還的**成員回家了。」

Practice 19

> “One **surviving** copy of the document remains.”

「這份文件只剩下一份**留存至今的**副本。」

surviving = 在其他**人 / 物**已消失、死亡或毀壞後仍然存在的

Important distinction: **survive vs live**

live

simply means be alive.

survive

emphasizes remaining alive **despite danger, difficulty, or threat**.

> “The turtle lives in the ocean.”

= 海龜生活在海洋。

> “The turtle survives harsh conditions.”

= 海龜在惡劣環境下仍能生存。

So **survive** contains the extra idea of overcoming difficulty.

Important distinction: **survive vs endure**

endure

means continue through pain, difficulty, or unpleasant conditions.

survive

means remain alive or continue existing after them.

You can:

> endure pain

without the issue being whether you stay alive.

So:

endure = 忍受 / 熬過

survive = 存活 / 繼續存在

Important distinction: **survive vs recover**

survive

= continue living/existing through the danger.

recover

= return to a better or normal condition afterward.

Someone may:

> survive an illness

but still need months to:

> recover.

This connects nicely with **resilient**:

> resilience often includes recovery after survival.

Important distinction: **survive vs escape**

escape

means get away from danger or confinement.

survive

means remain alive despite the danger.

A person can survive a dangerous situation without escaping from it immediately.

Important distinction: **survive vs outlive**

outlive

specifically means live longer than someone or something.

survive

can also mean this:

> “She survived her husband by ten years.”

But **outlive** is the more direct everyday verb for that relationship.

Countability note

Survive is a verb, so countability does not apply.

But:

survival

is usually uncountable when referring generally to staying alive:

> “Survival depends on water.”

It can be countable in specialized uses such as:

> “the survival of an ancient tradition”

where it refers to one case of continued existence.

survivor

is countable:

> a survivor

> several survivors

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **survive**

* **survived**

* **surviving**

* **survival**

* **survivor**

Useful constructions include:

* survive an accident

* survive harsh conditions

* survive on little food

* survive for years

* survive someone

* be survived by someone

The Golden Manual says useful grammatical constructions and family forms should be included, while contexts that still share the same underlying idea should be merged conservatively.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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survive — stay alive	面對危險、疾病、惡劣環境等威脅時仍繼續活着
survive — continue to exist	傳統、建築、組織、制度等在時間或困難中仍然存在
survive — continue operating	組織、企業或系統在壓力或危機下仍維持運作；屬於 continued-existence 義
survive someone	比某人活得更久，在對方死後仍然在世
survive an experience	成功熬過困難、疲累或不愉快的經歷；與 endure/stay-alive 義相關

survival	繼續生存或存在的狀態 / 能力	
survivor	經歷危險、災難、疾病等後仍然活着的人 / 生物	
surviving	在其他入 / 物已消失後仍然存在或活着的	

For your original sentence

> “They seem peaceful, but they also **survive** long journeys and harsh natural conditions.”

The exact meaning is:

****survive = 面對漫長旅程和惡劣自然條件時，仍然能夠活下來並繼續生存****

So:

> ****survive long journeys and harsh conditions****

= ****經得起漫長旅程和惡劣環境，仍能存活****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****survive****:

1. ****stay alive despite danger, difficulty, or harsh conditions****
2. ****continue to exist or function despite time/change/difficulty****
3. ****live longer than another person — survive someone / be survived by****

I would merge informal ****survive an exam/meeting**** into #1 as an exaggerated endurance extension, and keep ****survival, survivor, surviving**** as family forms rather than inflate the core count.